FIFTH SEMESTER FYUGP END SEMESTER EXAMINATION, 2026

MG5DSCPSY300- DYNAMICS OF RESEARCH IN PSYCHOLOGY

MODEL QUESTION PAPER

Time: 2 hrs **Max. marks: 70**

Part A. Multiple choice questions. (1-10). Each question carries 1 mark each.

1. Which feature most distinguishes scientific research from ordinary observation?

A. It relies primarily on personal experience
B. It follows a systematic and verifiable procedure
C. It focuses only on quantitative data
D. It avoids the use of theoretical explanations

2. Research conducted to solve a specific practical problem is called

A. Fundamental research
B. Applied research
C. Historical research
D. Conceptual research

3. A researcher reports all findings, including those that contradict the original expectations. This practice primarily reflects which characteristic of good research?

A. Objectivity
B. Flexibility
C. Generalizability
D. Economical use of resources

4. The primary purpose of reviewing previous research is to

A. Avoid collecting data
B. Understand existing knowledge on the topic
C. Replace the research problem
D. Increase the sample size

5. Which situation provides the strongest basis for claiming a research gap?

A. Very few studies have been conducted on the topic in a particular population
B. The researcher finds the topic personally interesting
C. The topic has received considerable media attention
D. The researcher prefers a different statistical technique

6. A well-defined research problem should be

A. Very broad and general
B. Clear and specific
C. Based only on personal opinion
D. Difficult to measure

7. A researcher categorizes participants according to their preferred mode of transportation: bus, train, bicycle, or car. Which measurement scale is being used?

A. Nominal
B. Ordinal
C. Interval
D. Ratio

8. A researcher predicts that students receiving a mindfulness intervention will have lower anxiety scores than students in the control group. What makes this a directional hypothesis?

A. It specifies the expected direction of the difference
B. It assumes that no difference will occur
C. It does not involve measurable variables
D. It specifies only the research population

9. Which feature is most important when selecting a research design for a study intended to determine whether an intervention causes a change in behaviour?

A. The researcher's personal preference
B. The ability of the design to establish causal relationships
C. The number of variables mentioned in the title
D. The availability of secondary data

10. A researcher develops a new psychological questionnaire and finds that its items consistently measure the intended construct. Which property of the tool is most directly being evaluated?

A. Reliability
B. Validity
C. Sampling adequacy
D. Generalizability

(10 X 1 = 10 marks)

Part B. Short essay type questions. Answer any 6 out of 8 (5 marks each).

11. Define scientific research and explain any four characteristics of scientific research.

12. Differentiate between fundamental research and applied research, giving one example of each.

13. Briefly explain the major steps involved in conducting psychological research.

14. What is a variable? Explain any four types of variables used in psychological research with suitable examples.

15. Define a research hypothesis and explain its functions in psychological research.

16. What is a research design? Explain the main features of a good research design.

17. Explain the major methods of data collection used in psychological research.

18. Briefly explain the difference between qualitative and quantitative data analysis with suitable examples.

(6 X 5 = 30 marks)

Part C. Essay type questions. Answer any 2 out of 4 (15 marks each)

19. Explain the importance and major methods of reviewing literature in psychological research. How does a literature review contribute to developing a theoretical or conceptual framework?

20. Explain the major probability and non-probability sampling methods used in psychological research. Discuss the suitability of any two methods with examples.

21. Explain the major types of research designs used in psychology. Discuss the factors that should be considered when selecting an appropriate research design.

22. Explain the major ethical principles involved in psychological research. Discuss their importance in protecting participants during data collection.

(2 X 15 =30 marks)